

Once to every soul and nation

*But the soul is still oracular; amid the market's din,
List the ominous stern whisper from the Delphic cave within,—
"They enslave their children's children who make compromise with sin"*

Text: James Russell Lowell, 1845

Music: Thomas John Williams, 1890

EBENEZER 87.87.87.87

The musical score is written for a single melodic line in treble clef, 12/8 time, with a key signature of one flat (Bb). The melody is composed of eighth and quarter notes, often beamed in groups of three. Chord symbols are placed above the staff at the beginning of each measure. The lyrics are arranged in three systems, with three verses of text aligned under the notes. The first system contains the first line of each verse, the second system the second line, and the third system the third line. The score concludes with a double bar line.

Chord symbols: Dm, A, Bb, A, Dm, F, C, Dm, A7, Dm, Dm, A, Bb, A, Dm, F, C, Dm, A7, Dm, F, C, Dm, A, Dm, C, Dm, C, F, Dm, A, Bb, A, Dm, F, C, Dm, A7, Dm.

1 Once to ev - 'ry soul and na - tion comes the mo - ment to de - cide,
2 New oc - ca-sions teach new du - ties, time makes an - cient good un-couth;
3 Though the cause of e - vil pros-per, yet 'tis truth a - lone is strong;

in the strife of truth with false-hood, for the good or e - vil side;
they must up-ward still and on - ward who would keep a - breast of truth.
though her por-tion be the scaf - fold, and up - on the throne be wrong.

Then to side with truth is no - ble, when we share her wretch-ed crust,
Lo, be - fore us gleam her camp-fires! We our - selves must pil - grims be,
Then it is the brave one choos - es, while the cow - ard stands a - side

ere her cause bring fame and prof - it, and 'tis prosp-'rous to be just;
nor at - tempt the fu - ture's por - tal with the past's blood - rus - ted key.
till the mul - ti - tude make vir - tue of the faith they had de-nied.